

Green Spectrum

Transformation Playbook

A practical handbook for moving beyond compliance towards systems thinking, better decision-making and organisational transformation.



What is this book?

Green Spectrum is a practical operating system for sustainability transformation.

It has been developed to help organisations move beyond reporting and compliance towards meaningful organisational change.

Rather than providing another sustainability framework, Green Spectrum connects systems thinking, facilitation, innovation and decision-making into one practical process.

This handbook is designed to help sustainability leaders

- Understand complex systems
- Identify meaningful opportunities
- Align stakeholders
- Make informed decisions
- Design interventions
- Learn through experimentation



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WHAT THIS PLAYBOOK IS

This is not another sustainability framework. Most organisations already know sustainability matters. The challenge is knowing where to begin.

How to prioritise. How to engage people

How to navigate complexity. How to make better decisions.

Green Spectrum provides a practical operating system that helps organisations understand complexity before trying to solve it.

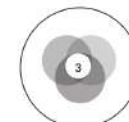
It combines systems thinking, facilitation, sustainability practice and innovation into one connected process.

This playbook helps you:

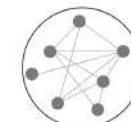
- Understand your organisation as a system
- Identify sustainability challenges
- Prioritise opportunities
- Engage stakeholders
- Design interventions
- Learn through experimentation

Green Spectrum is not a reporting tool. It is a navigation system.

The Green Spectrum makes the complex navigable.



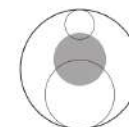
1. Explore with the 3 Empathies



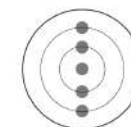
2. Map the Problem Landscape



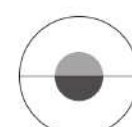
3. Sort with Spectrum & Complexity



4. Prioritise & Select Focus



5. Decision Tree & Experiment



6. Reflect, Learn, Evolve



Designed for people leading sustainability change.

Primary users

- Chief Sustainability Officers
- Sustainability Managers
- ESG Leads
- Transformation Leads
- Innovation Teams

Secondary users

- Consultants
- Service Designers
- Programme Managers
- Strategy Teams
- Cross-functional Sustainability Team

Green Spectrum works whether you are beginning your sustainability journey or leading transformation across an entire organisation.

If your role involves helping people make better sustainability decisions, **this playbook is designed for you.**



From Reporting to Transformation

For many organisations, sustainability begins with

- reporting | • Collecting data | • Responding to legislation | • Producing disclosures | • Monitoring targets.

These activities are essential, but they rarely create transformation on their own. Transformation happens when sustainability becomes part of how decisions are made across the organisation.

Traditional Sustainability Role

- Collects data
- Produces reports
- Tracks compliance
- Measures performance
- Monitors progress

Green Spectrum Approach

- Connects people
- Designs conversations
- Builds shared understanding
- Identifies leverage points
- Creates organisational learning

Green Spectrum helps shift the role of sustainability from reporting performance to designing better systems, conversations and decisions.

Key Insight

The future sustainability leader is not only an expert. They are also a facilitator, systems thinker and change leader.



Five Principles for Sustainability Transformation.

Before using tools, we must first change how we think.

01/ Sustainability is a systems challenge

Environmental, social and economic issues are interconnected. Solving one issue in isolation often creates another elsewhere.

02/ Sustainability belongs to everyone

Transformation happens through collaboration, not ownership by a single department

03/ Complexity is normal.

You do not need perfect information before taking action. Progress begins with understanding.

04/ Learning is more valuable than certainty

The best solutions emerge through testing, reflection and continuous improvement.

05/ Participation creates ownership

People support what they help create. The quality of the conversation shapes the quality of the outcome.

Better sustainability begins with better thinking.



Three Layers. One Connected System. Green Spectrum operates across three interconnected layers.

*These three layers work together continuously.
Changing tools without changing mindset creates limited impact. Changing mindset without building capability create little lasting change. True transformation happens when all three work together.*

Key Message

Mindset drives behaviour. Skillset enables action.
Capability creates lasting change.

CAPABILITY

How your organisation performs. The behaviours, structures and decision-making processes that embed sustainability into everyday operations.

SKILLSET

How you work.
The tools, canvases, workshops and methods that help teams understand and solve problems.

MINDSET

How you think.
The beliefs, values and perspectives that influence sustainability decisions.



A Six-Step System for Navigating Sustainability Every project, workshop and decision within Green Spectrum follows the same six-step process.

01/ DISCOVER

Understand people, organisations and environmental systems.

02/ MAP

Make relationships, impacts and behaviours visible.

03/ STRUCTURE

Organise complexity and identify patterns.

04/ PRIORITISE

Focus on the challenges that offer the greatest opportunity for change.

05/ DECIDE

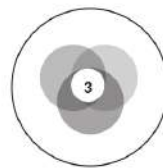
Evaluate opportunities and select the most appropriate pathway forward.

06 / EXPERIMENT

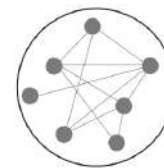
Test ideas, generate evidence and build organisational learning.

The process is not linear.
You may revisit earlier stages as new information emerges. Learning continues throughout the journey

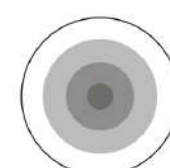
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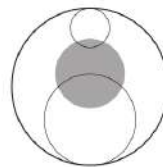
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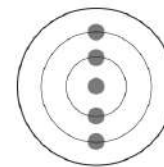
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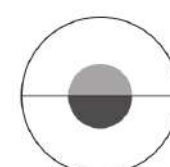
3. Sort with Spectrum & Complexity



4. Prioritise & Select Focus



5. Decision Tree & Experiment



6. Reflect, Learn, Evolve



Three Ways to Use Green Spectrum. **Green Spectrum is designed to be flexible.**

Whether you are working alone, facilitating a workshop or leading organisation wide transformation, the same process applies.

SOLO MODE

Use the playbook as a structured thinking tool. Complete canvases independently. Reflect, map and develop ideas before involving others. Ideal for research, planning and early-stage strategy.

TEAM MODE

Use the playbook to facilitate workshops. Bring together diverse perspectives. Build shared understanding. Create collective ownership of decisions. Ideal for project teams and cross-functional collaboration.

ORGANISATIONAL MODE

Apply Green Spectrum across multiple teams and departments. Use a shared language, common process and connected outputs to support long-term transformation. Ideal for strategic sustainability programmes.

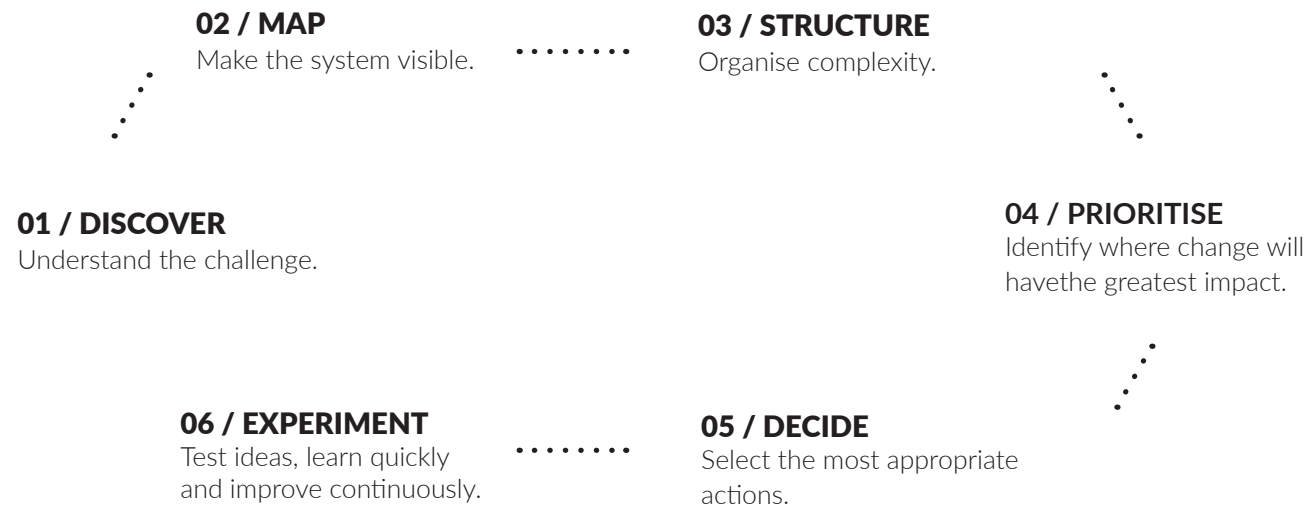
Remember

This playbook is not intended to be read from cover to cover in one sitting. **Return to the relevant sections as your project evolves.** Each chapter is designed to support a specific stage of your sustainability journey.



The Green Spectrum Transformation System

Green Spectrum is built around a repeatable six-step process that helps organisations move from uncertainty to informed action. **Each step builds on the previous one, creating a structured pathway through complexity.** Rather than jumping directly to solutions, the system encourages teams to understand problems, identify opportunities and test ideas before committing significant resources.



Test ideas, learn quickly and improve continuously.

Each step has:

- A purpose
- A canvas
- A workshop activity
- A clear output

Together they create an organisational learning system rather than a one-off project.

Key Principle
Don't skip steps.
The quality of your decisions depends on the quality of your understanding.

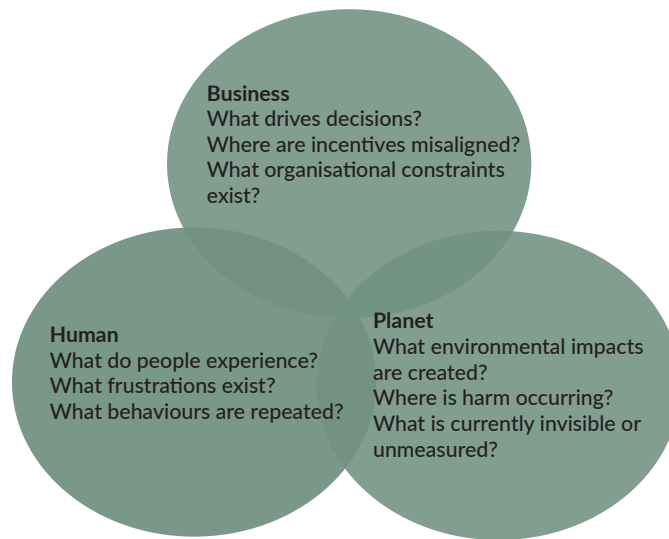


STEP 1: DISCOVER

Understand the system before attempting to change it.
Every sustainability challenge exists within a wider system of people, organisations and environmental impacts.

The purpose of Discover is to build a shared understanding of that system. At this stage, avoid discussing solutions. Instead, focus on learning.

Use the Three Empathies Canvas
Explore the challenge through three connected perspectives:



Output

- Shared understanding
- Key insights
- Behaviour patterns
- Areas of tension

Remember
Understanding comes before intervention.

Each section includes a key guiding question, followed by 4 maturity levels (White, Light Green, Mid Green, Dark Green), reflecting organisational progress from knowing to regenerative leadership.

1. Strategy and Purpose Alignment

Question: How is sustainability embedded in the strategic vision and purpose of the organisation?

- White: No stated sustainability goals or long-term environmental considerations in business strategy.
- Light Green: Mission includes sustainability language; compliance-driven ESG goals aligned with reporting standards.
- Mid Green: Purpose integrates sustainability into core business goals and value proposition across departments.
- Dark Green: Strategy is regenerative by design, aiming to restore ecosystems and social systems, advancing industry norms.

2. Governance and Leadership

Question: How is sustainability governed and led at senior levels?

- White: No governance mechanisms for sustainability; no responsibility assigned.
- Light Green: Board-level oversight with sustainability KPIs; sustainability lead or committee appointed.
- Mid Green: Sustainability embedded into executive performance, KPIs, incentives, and board narratives.
- Dark Green: Leadership acts as public advocates for transformation; board includes non-executive and intergenerational representation.

3. Organisational Culture and Engagement

Question: How embedded is sustainability in the organisation's day-to-day culture and behaviour?

- White: No awareness of sustainability at operational or staff level.
- Light Green: All staff having and awareness campaign on compliance and reporting.
- Mid Green: Structured employee engagement programmes; sustainability champions across departments.
- Dark Green: Culture of learning, action, and ownership; all staff support regenerative decision-making.

4. Stakeholder Engagement and Co-Design

Question: How are stakeholders engaged in shaping the sustainability agenda?

- White: Stakeholders only rely on external regulators or markets.
- Light Green: Services and annual reports published for investors and regulators.
- Mid Green: Regular on-boarding sessions with external suppliers, users, and workers.
- Dark Green: Deep, long-term participatory design processes; affected communities shape governance.

5. Materiality and Systems Risk Mapping

Question: How effectively does the organisation map and prioritise material issues and systemic risks?

- White: No materiality or risk mapping undertaken.
- Light Green: Core materiality assessment; alignment to global standards.
- Mid Green: Dynamic systems mapping tools used for materiality and systemic risks.
- Dark Green: Full feedback loop model connecting planetary boundaries, tipping points, and justice metrics.

6. Transparency and Accountability

Question: How transparent and accountable is the organisation for sustainability performance?

- White: No public disclosure or performance tracking.
- Light Green: Basic annual ESG disclosures; data disclosure.
- Mid Green: Third-party verified; broad-based metrics published in real time.
- Dark Green: Transparent open data ecosystems; participatory auditing with communities and NGOs.

7. Metrics and Impact Measurement

Question: Are metrics focused on short-term outputs or long-term, meaningful impact?

- White: No metrics or only financial ones tracked.
- Light Green: Outputs, mostly energy tracked at Site 1 and 2 level.
- Mid Green: Scope 1, 2, and 3 metrics; biodiversity and circularity indicators used.
- Dark Green: Measures of ecosystem regeneration, well-being, community wealth, and intergenerational justice.

8. Product and Service Innovation

Question: Are sustainability criteria influencing the design and delivery of products and services?

- White: Product designed for market fit and profitability only.
- Light Green: Eco-efficiency improvements (e.g. lighter packaging).
- Mid Green: Circular design principles selected across all new products or services.
- Dark Green: Products act as regenerative interventions in the world (e.g. restoring biodiversity, building local economies).

9. Operational Integration and Circularity

Question: How embedded is sustainability in core operations and supply chains?

- White: Sustainability is treated as external to operations.
- Light Green: ESG contributions, carbon audits, or procurement checks in place.
- Mid Green: Supply chain validated for circularity, resilience, and feasibility.
- Dark Green: Operations designed as closed-loop, zero-waste, and relative to local ecosystems.

10. Finance, Budgeting and Investment

Question: How are capital flows aligned with long-term sustainability and regeneration?

- White: No dedicated budget or sustainable financial products.
- Light Green: Green bonds or ESG screens used in treasury activities.
- Mid Green: Internal carbon pricing; investment criteria favouring impact-driven outcomes.
- Dark Green: Building capital to repair ecosystems, social innovation, or planetary infrastructure.

11. Data Systems and Digital Enablement

Question: How is digital technology used to enhance sustainability tracking and action?

- White: No data captured or analysed for sustainability.
- Light Green: Spreadsheets or third-party platforms for emissions tracking.
- Mid Green: Integrated data systems for real-time ESG reporting across business units.
- Dark Green: AI and digital twins used for regenerative modelling, forecasting, and climate science.

12. Policy and Regulatory Alignment

Question: How well does the organisation respond to and shape evolving policy landscapes?

- White: No awareness or tracking of relevant policy-related policy.
- Light Green: Compliance with existing regulatory frameworks (e.g. CSRD).
- Mid Green: Internal working groups align future strategy with regulatory shifts; proactive lobbying for just transition.
- Dark Green: Leads policy to enable transparent advocacy for equity-based, regenerative legislation.

13. Collaboration and Ecosystem Partnerships

Question: How strategically does the company partner with others to drive systems change?

- White: Greening in isolation or competition with peers.
- Light Green: Member of sustainability networks or certification schemes.
- Mid Green: Strategic alliances with supply chain partners, academia, and NGOs to build circular infrastructures.
- Dark Green: Actively builds coalitions for systemic transformation; results in common-based governance.

Each section includes a key guiding question, followed by 4 maturity levels (White, Light Green, Mid Green, Dark Green), reflecting organisational progress from knowing to regenerative leadership.

14. Behavioural Change and Internal Enablers

Question: How are employees incentivised and enabled to act in line with sustainability goals?

- White: No connection between sustainability and roles, training, or performance.
- Light Green: Basic compliance training; optional sustainability modules offered.
- Mid Green: Sustainability linked to KPIs, job descriptions, and team performance metrics.
- Dark Green: Cultural shifts; goals to learn, learning, and regenerative leadership practices embedded throughout.

15. Customer Empowerment and Engagement

Question: How are customers informed, involved, or empowered in sustainability efforts?

- White: No communication on sustainability; customers viewed as transactional.
- Light Green: Sustainability topics on store media to product descriptions.
- Mid Green: Management education and tools provided for customer dialogue and participation.
- Dark Green: Customers co-create solutions, provide data, or influence regenerative business evolution.

16. Ecosystem Stewardship and Regeneration

Question: Does the organisation support ecological regeneration beyond compliance?

- White: No involvement or acknowledgment of ecosystem health.
- Light Green: Other schemes or biodiversity strategies through third parties.
- Mid Green: Active regeneration projects; e.g. wetland restoration, agrobiodiversity trials.
- Dark Green: Focus based on management, community-led development, and regenerative infrastructure investments.

17. Value Chain Integration and Traceability

Question: How traceable and aligned are value chain partners with sustainability principles?

- White: No traceability framework or audit trail.
- Light Green: Supplier codes of conduct and audit trailability limited.
- Mid Green: Digital traceability of environmental and social impacts across the 1-3 supply chain.
- Dark Green: Full visibility and engagement of supply ecosystem; fostering regenerative practices and knowledge.

18. Circular Design and Materials Strategy

Question: Are materials and product designs aligned with circularity and environmental performance?

- White: No material guidance or lifecycle thinking in design.
- Light Green: Single material substitution (e.g. recycled).
- Mid Green: Comprehensive circular design framework; design for disassembly or reuse.
- Dark Green: Bio-circular design; design for the positive outcomes across portfolios.

19. Climate and Biodiversity Integration

Question: How are climate risks and nature loss embedded into planning and performance?

- White: No consideration of climate or nature loss in strategy.
- Light Green: Carbon footprinting and alignment with climate disclosure standards.
- Mid Green: Science-based targets; nature loss assessment of use, sourcing, and restoration.
- Dark Green: Regenerative climate action and ecosystem regeneration through strategic investment.

20. Innovation Capacity and R&D Alignment

Question: Is innovation directed toward sustainable and regenerative outcomes?

- White: R&D focused solely on market expansion and profit.
- Light Green: Dedicated budget for incremental sustainability innovations (e.g. lighter packaging).
- Mid Green: Circular and inclusive innovations across R&D, marketing, and operations.
- Dark Green: Future-oriented, mission-led innovation aligned with planetary and societal thresholds.

21. Human and Community Wellbeing

Question: How does the organisation support wellbeing and equity internally and in communities?

- White: Wellbeing and equity not considered; minimal social protections.
- Light Green: Employee benefits and standardised CSR efforts.
- Mid Green: Living wage, mental health programmes, and equity assessments across operations.
- Dark Green: Long-term partnerships with communities; regeneration of local economies and social systems.

22. Learning and Adaptation Mechanisms

Question: How does the organisation sense, learn, and adapt to sustainability challenges?

- White: No learning systems in place; reactive to external pressure.
- Light Green: Formal sustainability training offered; annual retrospectives.
- Mid Green: Ongoing feedback loops with staff, stakeholders, and data tools.
- Dark Green: Regenerative learning cycles; experimentation and reflective practices drive strategy.

23. Crisis Readiness and Resilience

Question: Is the business prepared to navigate ecological, economic, or societal disruption?

- White: No adaptation strategy; vulnerable to shocks.
- Light Green: Contingency planning for known climate or regulatory risks.
- Mid Green: Stress testing, scenario planning, and adaptive planning processes in place.
- Dark Green: Organisational agility; capacity to thrive in uncertainty through distributed systems and mutual aid structures.

24. Equity, Justice and Inclusion

Question: How are justice and equity embedded into sustainability efforts?

- White: No DEI or justice considerations; diversity tokenism present.
- Light Green: Diversity pledges or training for leadership teams.
- Mid Green: Equity-centred design; disaggregated data tracking; justice criteria in procurement.
- Dark Green: Anti-oppressive practice embedded; intersectional systems change co-led by marginalised groups.

25. Regenerative Business Identity and Influence

Question: Is the company redefining what it means to be a business in a planetary emergency?

- White: Company views itself as a value-maximising economic actor.
- Light Green: Business responds to compliance or investor pressure with risk framing.
- Mid Green: Purpose of social identity, acting as an external or circular or low-carbon value creator.
- Dark Green: Business acts as a movement partner, moral actor, and shaper of futures beyond profit - including ecological trusteeship and intergenerational accountability.

2

STEP 2: Map

Make complexity visible.

Once you understand the challenge, the next step is to visualise how the system works.

Mapping helps teams see relationships that are often hidden. Instead of focusing on individual problems, focus on interactions.

Create an Impact Journey Map

Impact Mapping Journey Canvas

What challenge, opportunity, or system are we exploring?

STAGE / PHASE	Stake Holders Involved	Key Activities	Assumptions & Unknowns	Interdependencies & System Interactions	User Emotions & Experience	Environmental Impact	Social Impact	Governance Impact
STAGE 1								
STAGE 2								
STAGE 3								
STAGE 4								
STAGE 5								

For each stage identify:

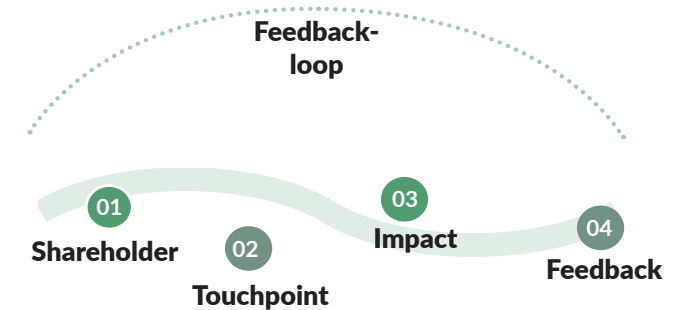
- Stakeholders
- Actions
- Decisions
- Emotions
- Data
- Environmental impacts
- Business impacts
- Unknowns

Look for:

- Bottlenecks
- Feedback loops
- Dependencies
- Opportunities

Output

- End-to-end system map
- Shared understanding
- Cause-and-effect relationships



Key Principle

If people cannot see the system, they cannot improve it.



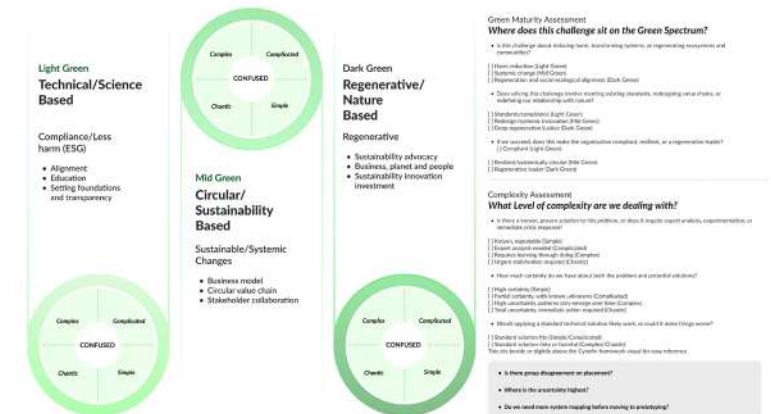
Organise complexity.

Not every sustainability challenge requires the same response. Some problems are simple. Others are highly complex. Structure helps teams classify issues before deciding what to do next.

Use Two Connected Frameworks Green Spectrum

Identify the sustainability ambition of each issue.

- White Compliance
- Light Green Efficiency
- Mid Green Improvement
- Dark Green Transformation



Complexity Matrix

Classify each issue as:

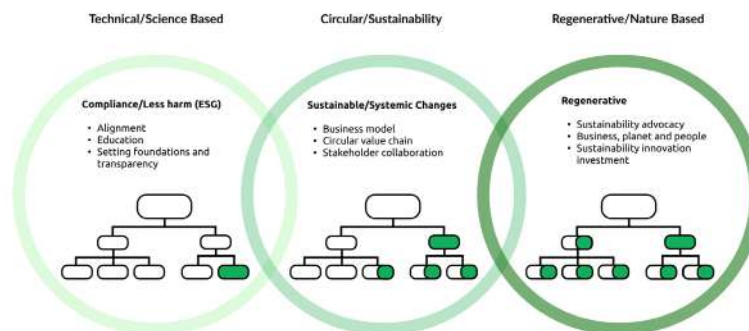
- Simple
- Complicated
- Complex
- Chaotic

Together these tools reveal which challenges deserve attention first.

Output

- Sustainability Heatmap
- Complexity profile
- Priority clusters

The Green Spectrum



Prioritise

Focus on the opportunities that matter most.

Organisations often have too many sustainability initiatives competing for attention.

Prioritisation creates focus. Rather than asking, "What can we do?" Ask, **"What should we do first?"**

Use the Opportunity Tree
Start with one clearly defined challenge. Then explore

- Root causes
- Stakeholders
- Leverage points
- Intervention opportunities
- Time horizons

Consider interventions across:

- Behaviour
- Process
- Policy
- Technology
- Services
- Products
- Business Models

Organise ideas into:

Immediate 0–3 months

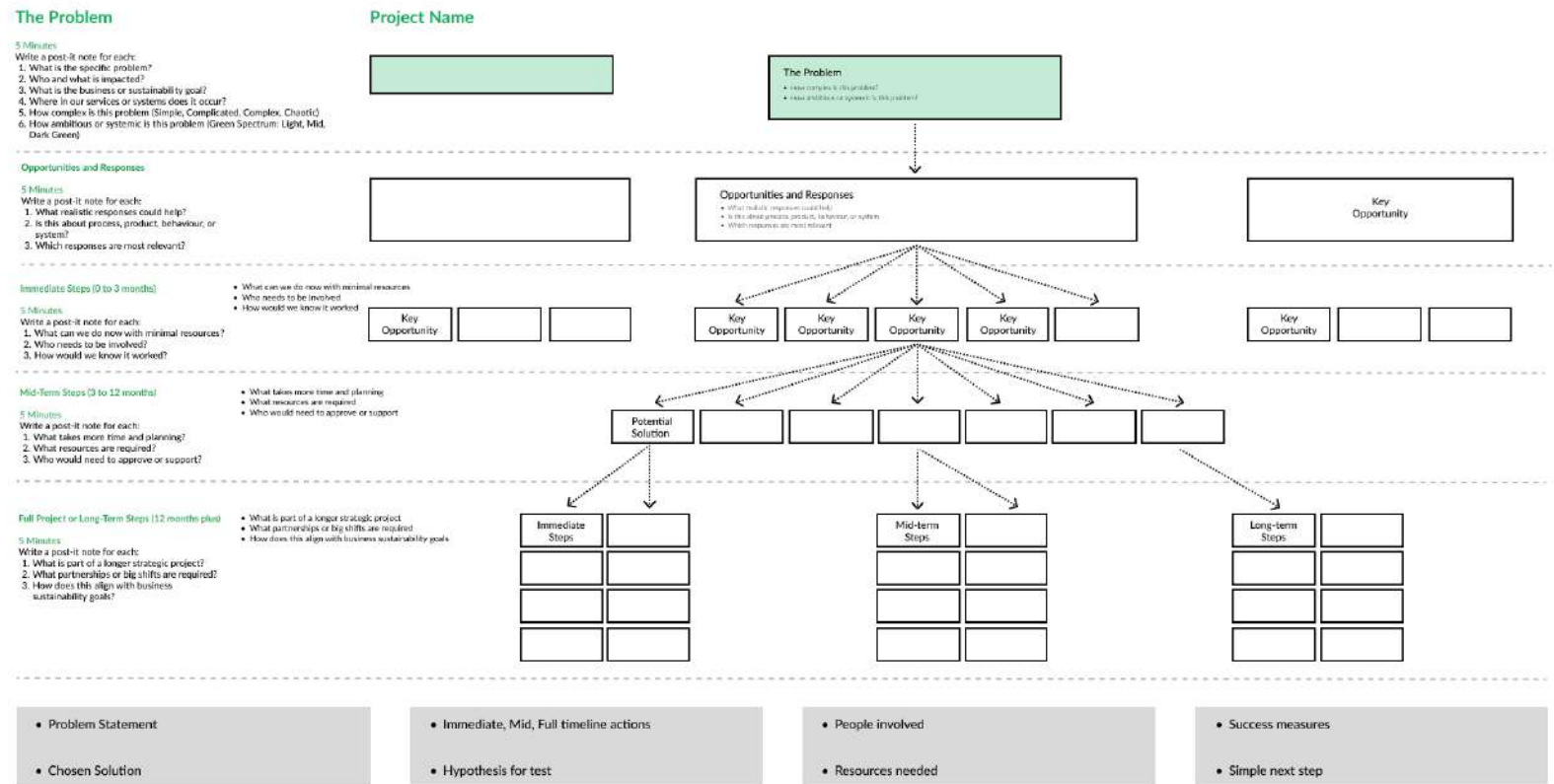
Medium-term 3–12 months

Long-term 12+ months

Output

- Opportunity Tree
- Intervention Portfolio
- Prioritised Opportunities

Opportunity Mapping Tree



STEP5 : DECIDE

Decide| Turn opportunities into confident decisions.

Prioritisation identifies where change should happen.

Decision-making determines what should happen next.

Green Spectrum uses a structured approach to reduce uncertainty before committing time, money and resources.

Use the Decision Tree

Evaluate every opportunity by asking

01. Is the problem clearly understood?

Do we have enough evidence?

Do stakeholders agree?

02. Does it align with our strategy?

Does it support organisational goals?

Will it create meaningful impact?

03. Can we influence it?

Do we have direct control?

Can we influence it through partners?

04. Do we have the capability?

People, Skills, Technology, Budget, Governance

05. Is the level of risk acceptable?

Operational, Financial, Environmental, Reputational

06. Can it be tested?

Can we learn before scaling? / Can success be measured?

People Skills, Technology, Budget, Governance

Is the level of risk acceptable?

Operational, Financial, Environmental, Reputational

Can it be tested?

Can we learn before scaling?

Can success be measured?

(Large vertical Decision Tree with Yes / No branches leading to four coloured outcomes: Proceed, Experiment, Pause and Archive. Small explanatory text sits alongside the diagram.)

Decision Outcomes

Proceed

Ready for implementation.

Experiment

Test before investing.

Pause

Review later when conditions improve.

Archive

Capture learning and move on.

Output

- Prioritised decisions

- Clear ownership

- Agreed next actions

Key Principle
Good decisions are based on evidence, not opinion.

Experiment

Learn through action. No organisation can predict the perfect solution.
Transformation happens by testing ideas, gathering evidence and adapting over time.
Experiments reduce uncertainty while building confidence. Rather than asking,
"What is the perfect solution?"

Ask, **"What is the smallest experiment that will help us learn?"**

Every experiment should answer five questions

- **What are we testing?**
- **Why are we testing it?**
- **Who is involved?**
- **How will success be measured?**
- **What will we learn?**

Build an Innovation Portfolio
Balance your work across three horizons.

Horizon 1 → Improve today's systems.
Horizon 2 → Develop emerging opportunities.
Horizon 3 → Create transformational futures.

Output

- Experiment Cards
- Learning Plan
- Innovation Portfolio
- Evidence for future decisions

Field - Description Experiment Title - Concise project name Green Spectrum Stage - Light / Mid / Dark Green Complexity Domain - Clear / Complicated / Complex / Chaotic / Disorder Empathy Lens - Human / Business / Planetary		Prototype Type (tick all that apply) ☐ Behavioural Design ☐ ESG or Reporting Tool ☐ Material or Packaging Trial ☐ Digital or Tech Tool ☐ Service or Workflow Blueprint ☐ Brand or Messaging Prototype ☐ Workplace Culture Pilot ☐ Community or Social Innovation ☐ Circular Business Model Prototype ☐ Nature-based or Planetary Trial ☐ Other		Testing Plan Field - Description Key Metrics or KPIs - e.g., waste reduction %, uptake % Measurement Method - survey, LCA, sensor data, interview Time Frame - start and end date Observation Frequency - daily, weekly Data Collection Tools - log sheets, dashboards, forms	
Strategic Framing (Playing to Win)					
What is our winning aspiration? e.g., reduce packaging waste by 50% in 2 years -Where will we play - geography, department, supply chain node, user group - How will we win - unique advantage or value proposition		What capabilities must be in place? eg, team, tech, partnerships, external expertise -What management systems are required - dashboards, rituals, check-ins			
Resources, Ownership and Governance Project Owner - name/role Support Team - UX, operations, legal, finance, external Work Hours Estimate - person-hours Budget Estimate - monetary value Funding Source - department, fund, grant Accountability Lead - who will sign off Evaluation Success Criteria - what success looks like Failure Criteria - when to stop Learning Regardless - new insight we expect Learning Pathways Situation - Decision If positive - scale / next prototype / business case development If negative - reframe / redesign / test new context If inconclusive - gather further data or refine hypothesis Experiment Version - e.g., v1.0					
Pre-Test Decision Logic We will know the result was positive if- If result is positive, we will - We will know the result is negative if- If result is negative, we will - If result is inconclusive, we will -		Stakeholder Impact Mapping Who will be affected? Impact type - positive/negative Timeline - immediate / mid / long-term			
Learning Pathways Decision If positive - scale / next prototype / business case development If negative - reframe / redesign / test new context If inconclusive - gather further data or refine hypothesis Experiment Version - e.g., v1.0 Reflection and Confidence Field - Description Riskiest Assumption - single greatest risk to outcome Confidence Score - 1-10 with rationale Last Review Date: Next Review Date:					

In an innovation portfolio, teams are to complete three cards per problem with varying prototype scales:

- Early rapid prototype (low cost, quick feedback)
- Mid-scale pilot (moderate investment, deeper data) • Full pilot or policy test (pre-launch validation)

Key Principle
Progress comes through continuous learning, not perfect planning.



Nine Tools. One Connected System.

Each stage of Green Spectrum is supported by a practical tool designed to help teams think more clearly and make better decisions.

Every tool follows the same structure:

- Purpose
- Inputs
- Instructions
- Outputs
- Next Step

The value of these tools is not the canvas itself. The value comes from the conversations, insights and decisions they enable

01/ Discover
Three Empathies Canvas

02/ Map
Impact Journey Map

03/ Structure
Complexity Matrix

04/ Prioritise
Opportunity Tree

05/ Prioritise
Opportunity Tree

06/ Decide
Decision Tree

07/ Experiment
Three Horizons

08/ Experiment
Prototyping Wheel

09/ Experiment
Experiment Card

Key Principle

The process connects the tools.
The tools do not replace the process.



From Conversation to Action

Green Spectrum workshops are designed to create understanding, alignment and measurable outcomes. They are not presentations. They are structured environments for collective thinking.

Every workshop follows the same rhythm.

01. Think

Individual reflection before discussion.

2. Make Visible

Capture ideas using canvases and visual tools.

3. Structure

Organise information into themes and patterns.

4. Decide

Prioritise opportunities and agree next steps.

5. Act

Assign ownership and define experiments.

6. Learn

Capture insights and improve the process.

Every workshop should produce tangible outputs:

• Maps | • Decisions | • Actions | • Owners | • Risks | • Questions

If a workshop does not produce decisions, it is incomplete.

Key Principle

Conversations create understanding.
Understanding creates action



Transformation happens through participation.

Your Role is Not to Have All the Answers

Green Spectrum shifts the role of sustainability from expert to facilitator. A facilitator creates the conditions for better thinking. They guide conversations rather than control them. They help people understand complexity, challenge assumptions and make confident decisions together.

As a Sustainability Facilitator, you will:

- Design meaningful conversations.
- Make complex systems understandable.
- Encourage participation.
- Build shared understanding.
- Challenge assumptions.
- Help teams make evidence-based decisions.
- Create a culture of experimentation and learning.

Final Reflection

Green Spectrum is more than a collection of tools. It is a practical operating system for navigating sustainability transformation. Every map, canvas and workshop exists to help organisations make better decisions and create meaningful change.

The journey begins with understanding. Everything else builds from there.

Remember

People support what they help create. The quality of your facilitation will determine the quality of your outcomes.



WORKSHOP PRINCIPLES

Every Workshop Should Create Change
Green Spectrum workshops are designed to move people from discussion to action.

***Every activity should contribute towards a clear outcome.
Avoid presentations. Design participation.***

Think

Give participants time to reflect before speaking.

Make Visible

Capture ideas using canvases, sticky notes and visual mapping.

Structure

Organise information into themes and patterns.

Decide

Prioritise what matters most.

Act

Assign actions, owners and timelines.

Learn

Reflect on outcomes and improve continuously.

If a workshop finishes without decisions, ownership or next steps, it is incomplete.

Key Principle

Structure creates confidence.
Participation creates ownership.



Great Facilitators Design Better Conversations

The role of the facilitator is not to provide answers. It is to help the group discover them. Your responsibility is to guide the process while allowing participants to contribute their own expertise.

01. Control the structure, not the conversation.

Provide a clear process without directing outcomes.

02. Manage energy, not airtime.

Vary activities regularly to maintain engagement.

03. Encourage participation before opinion.

Allow everyone to contribute before drawing conclusions.

04. Capture thinking in real time.

Make ideas visible throughout the workshop.

05. Challenge assumptions with curiosity.

Use questions to deepen understanding rather than defend positions.

Facilitator Reminder

The best facilitators speak less and listen more.



PARTICIPATION

Better Participation Creates Better Decisions

People think differently. Some prefer to write. Some prefer to speak. Others need time to reflect before contributing. Design workshops that allow different thinking styles to emerge.

Include a mixture of activities:

- o Individual reflection.
- o Pair discussions
- o Small group activities
- o Whole group conversations
- o Visual mapping
- o Dot voting
- o Silent brainstorming
- o Reflection exercises

Remember

People support what they help create.



A Simple Workshop Structure

Every Green Spectrum workshop follows the same rhythm.

Welcome

Explain the purpose. Introduce the agenda. Set expectations.

Explore

Encourage individual thinking before discussion.

Map

Capture ideas visually. Look for patterns and relationships.

Discuss

Explore different perspectives. Challenge assumptions respectfully.

Decide

Agree priorities. Assign ownership. Confirm next steps.

Close

Review key outcomes. Identify immediate actions. Explain what happens next.

Workshop Outputs. Every workshop should produce:

Visual maps | Visual maps | Priorities | Action owners | Risks | Open questions



One Process. Nine Connected Tools.

Green Spectrum provides a library of practical canvases to support every stage of sustainability transformation.

Each canvas has a specific purpose and produces a defined output.

Please Note

- You do not need every canvas for every project.
- Choose the right tool for the decision you need to make.

Core Canvases

- **Three Empathies:**
Understand people, business and planet
- **Impact Journey Map:**
Visualise the system
- **Green Spectrum Heatmap:**
Assess sustainability maturity
- **Complexity Matrix:**
Classify challenges
- **Opportunity Tree:**
Identify leverage points

Advanced Tools

- **Decision Tree:**
Evaluate opportunities
- **Three Horizons:**
Build an innovation portfolio
- **Prototyping Wheel:**
Select prototype types
- **Experiment Card:**
Plan and measure experiments

Key Principle:

The process determines which canvas to use not the other way around.



The Three Empathies Canvas is the starting point for every Green Spectrum project.
Before discussing solutions, take time to understand the challenge from three connected perspectives.

Remember

The objective is understanding—not solving.

01/ HUMAN

Understand the people involved.

- What are people experiencing?
- What frustrations exist?
- What behaviours are repeated?
- What motivates change?

02 / BUSINESS

Understand the organisation.

- What drives decision-making?
- What KPIs influence behaviour?
- Where are constraints created?
- What commercial pressures exist?

03 / PLANET

Understand environmental impact.

- What environmental impacts occur?
- What resources are consumed?
- Where is harm externalised?
- What remains invisible?

OUTPUTS:

- Shared understanding | Stakeholder insights
- Behaviour patterns | System tensions



Canvas 02 – The Impact Journey Map helps teams understand how sustainability impacts move through a system. Rather than creating a process map, it visualises relationships, interactions and consequences.

Key Question

Where does a small change create a significant impact?

01 / MAP THE JOURNEY

Map each stage of the journey by identifying:

- Stakeholders & Behaviours
- Actions & Decisions
- Environmental & Business impacts
- Data & Unknowns

02 / SYSTEM ANALYSIS

Look for hidden system dynamics:

- Feedback loops
- Bottlenecks & Dependencies
- Moments of influence
- Hidden impacts

03 / OUTPUTS

What the canvas delivers:

- Shared systems understanding
- End-to-end impact journey
- Opportunities for intervention



Canvas 03 & 04

Understanding Sustainability and Complexity

Not every sustainability issue requires the same response.

These two tools work together to help teams understand both ambition and complexity.

01 / THE HEATMAP LEVELS

Position challenges across four levels:

- **White – Compliance:**
Meeting minimum requirements.
- **Light Green – Efficiency:**
Reducing waste and improving performance.
- **Mid Green – Improvement:**
Creating positive organisational change.
- **Dark Green – Transformation:**
Redesigning systems for regenerative outcomes.

02 / COMPLEXITY MATRIX

Assess each challenge across four domains:

- Simple (Clear cause and effect)
- Complicated (Requires experts)
- Complex (Unpredictable patterns)
- Chaotic (Immediate action needed)

03 / OUTPUTS

What these tools deliver together:

- Sustainability maturity profile
- Complexity assessment
- Priority clusters

Remember

Don't confuse difficult with complex.



Canvas 05 & 06

From Challenges to Decisions

Once challenges have been understood and organised, the next step is to identify opportunities and decide where to invest effort.

Key Principle

Strong decisions begin with strong questions.

01 / OPPORTUNITY TREE

Start with one clearly defined challenge. Before committing, explore the following branches:

- Root causes & Stakeholders
- Leverage points
- Intervention opportunities
- Time horizons

The objective is exploration before commitment.

02 / DECISION TREE

Evaluate each opportunity by asking six core questions:

- Do we understand the problem & align with strategy?
- Can we influence it & do we have capability?
- Is the level of risk acceptable & can we test it?

Decision Outcomes: Proceed | Experiment | Pause | Archive

03 / OUTPUTS

What these tools deliver together:

- Prioritised opportunity portfolio
- Clear decision pathways
- Agreed next actions



Canvas 07, 08 & 09

Turning Decisions into Learning.

Every important idea should be tested before it is scaled. Green Spectrum supports experimentation through three connected tools.

What's Next?

The Green Spectrum process is iterative.

Every experiment generates new evidence.

Every insight strengthens future decisions. Learnin never stops.

Three Horizons

Balance innovation across three timeframes.

01 / THREE HORIZONS

Balance innovation across three distinct timeframes to secure the future:

- **Horizon 1:** Improve existing systems.
- **Horizon 2:** Develop emerging opportunities.
- **Horizon 3:** Create transformationalfutures.

02 / PROTOTYPING & ITERATION

Select the most appropriate prototype format:

**Behaviour | Process | Service | Digital | Product |
Policy | Community | Organisation**

The Green Spectrum process is iterative. Every experiment generates new evidence.

03 / EXPERIMENT CARD & OUTPUTS

Every experiment must define: Hypothesis, Learning objective, Success measures, Owner, Resources, and Timeline.

Outputs:

- Experiment plan | Innovation portfolio
- Organisational learning

Closing Quote

Small experiments create lasting transformation.



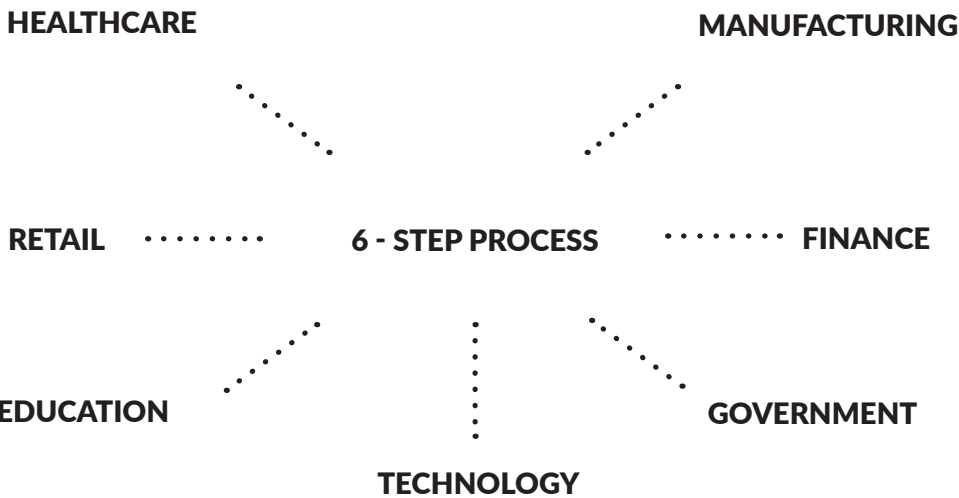
Every organisation is different. **The Green Spectrum framework** is designed to adapt to different sectors, challenges and levels of sustainability maturity.

The process remains consistent. The application changes.

To give you a clear overview of where the **Green Spectrum** can be deployed, here is a breakdown of strategic and operational focus areas:

Focus Area
Application Types
Strategic Alignment

- Sustainability strategy
- ESG programmes
- Net Zero planningValue Chain & Offerings
- Circular economy initiatives● Product innovation
- Service redesignInternal & Culture
- Organisational transformation
- Innovation programmes
- Cross-functional workshopsEcosystem & Network
- Stakeholder engagement



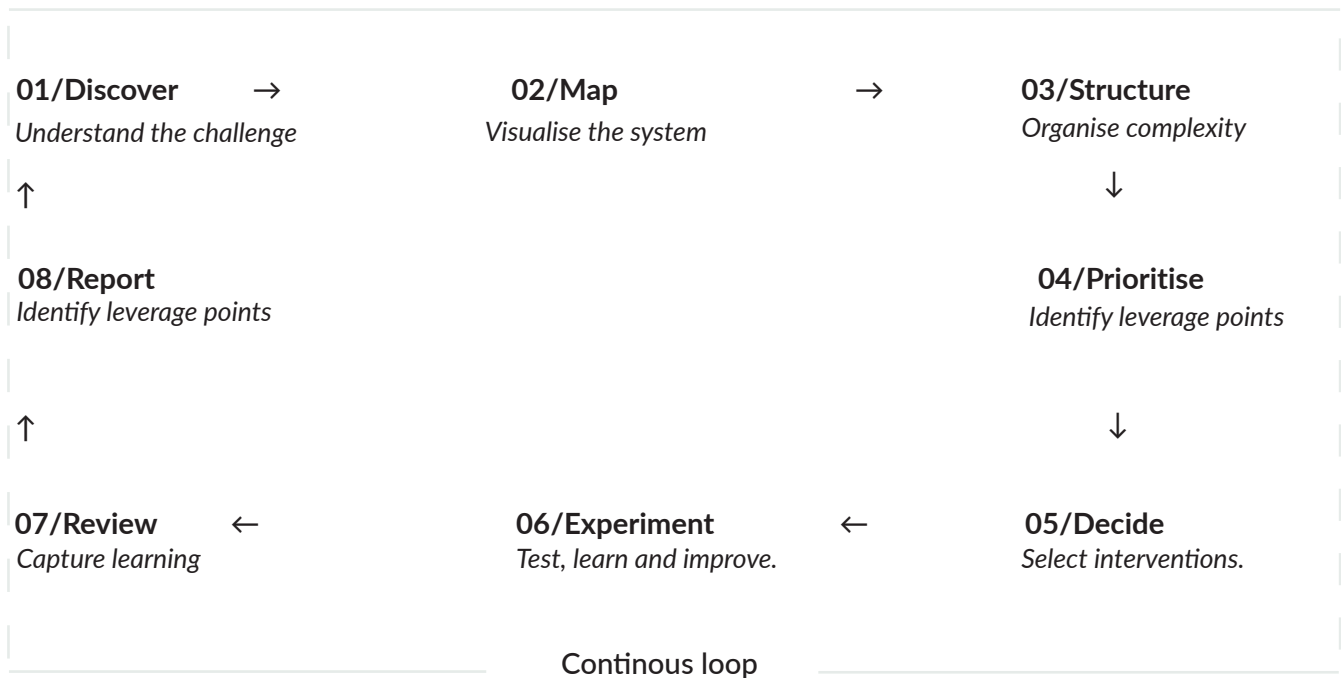
Key Principle
Apply the process consistently. Adapt the tools thoughtfully. **Green Spectrum** provides the structure. Your organisation provides the context.

A Typical Project Journey

Every Green Spectrum project follows the same overall journey. It acts as a continuous loop where each cycle builds organisational capability and each project strengthens future decision-making.

Remember

Green Spectrum is not a linear project methodology. It is a continuous learning system. Transformation is continuous.



Repeat

Transformation is continuous. Each cycle builds organisational capability.
Each project strengthens future decision-making.



Getting Started

If you're new to Green Spectrum, don't try to use every tool immediately.

Start small. Build confidence. Learn by doing.

Your First Green Spectrum Workshop

Follow these 8 straightforward steps to run your initial session and build momentum:

01. Define one sustainability challenge. Keep the scope narrow and actionable.
02. Complete the Three Empathies Canvas. Understand the perspectives within the system.
03. Create an Impact Journey Map. Track the cause-and-effect pathways.
04. Build an Opportunity Tree. Map out branches of potential interventions.
05. Select one opportunity. Pick the lowest-hanging fruit with high potential leverage.
06. Design one experiment. Define a quick, low-risk way to test your idea.
07. Review what you learned. Capture insights, failures, and unexpected outcomes.
08. Repeat the process. Improve each time.

Remember

Small projects build capability for larger transformation.



Before Every Workshop

Preparation creates confidence. Reflection creates improvement. Use this checklist to ensure your Green Spectrum sessions run smoothly from start to finish.

Phase 1: Preparation (Before)	Phase 2: Execution (During)	Phase 2: Execution (During)
<i>Complete these tasks before the session begins to set up for success.</i>	<i>Focus on these facilitation dynamics while the workshop is live.</i>	<i>Capture the momentum immediately after the session concludes.</i>
☐ Define the objective. Be crystal clear on what this specific workshop needs to achieve.	☐ Encourage participation. Ensure every voice in the room is heard, not just the loudest.	☐ Photograph outputs. Secure all physical canvas drawings and sticky notes digitally.
☐ Prepare the canvases. Have your Green Spectrum frameworks printed or loaded digitally.	☐ Capture thinking visually. Use the canvases to map out thoughts in real time.	☐ captured data to all participants quickly. Confirm actions. Clearly state the next steps moving forward.
☐ Invite the right participants. Ensure a diverse mix of perspectives and decision-makers.	☐ Keep discussions focused. Gently guide the team back if the conversation drifts.	☐ Assign ownership. Ensure every action item has a dedicated person attached to it.
☐ Prepare materials. Gather sticky notes, sharpies, timers, or digital collaboration tools.	☐ Challenge assumptions. Ask "Why?" to uncover hidden biases in the system.	☐ Schedule follow-up. Lock in the next meeting to maintain the project's velocity.
☐ Confirm timings. Structure the agenda with built-in buffers for deep discussions.	☐ Manage energy. Take regular breaks to keep momentum and focus high.	☐ Capture learning. Briefly reflect on what worked well in the workshop and what didn't
☐ Arrange the room. Set up the physical space or digital board to encourage collaboration.	☐ Record decisions. Explicitly document what is being agreed upon before moving on.	



Ten Principles to Remember

These principles underpin every Green Spectrum workshop, canvas and conversation. Return to them whenever you are unsure what to do next.

01/ Understand before solving.

02/ Make thinking visible.

03/ Design participation.

04/ Focus on systems, not symptoms.

05/ Challenge assumptions.

06 / Prioritise where change matters most.

07/ Test before scaling.

08/ Learn continuously.

09/ Build organisational capability.

10/ Sustainability is everyone's responsibility.

Better conversations create better systems.



Capability

The ability of an organisation to repeatedly create positive sustainability outcomes.

Complexity

The degree to which a challenge contains uncertainty, interdependence and changing relationships.

Experiment

A structured activity designed to generate learning before larger implementation.

Facilitator

A person who designs and guides conversations that enable better decisions.

Leverage Point

A place within a system where a small intervention can create significant change.

Systems Thinking

An approach that considers relationships, interactions and feedback rather than isolated problems.

Transformation

Fundamental change to the way an organisation creates value.



Influences Behind Green Spectrum

Green Spectrum combines ideas from sustainability, systems thinking, strategic design and innovation. This playbook brings these disciplines together into one practical operating system.

Key areas of influence include:

SYSTEMS THINKING

REGENERATIVE DESIGN

CIRCULAR ECONOMY

BEHAVIOUR CHANGE

DESIGN THINKING

ORGANISATIONAL LEARNING

SERVICE DESIGN

STRATEGIC FORESIGHT

TRANSITION DESIGN

INNOVATION MANAGEMENT



Green Spectrum has been shaped through research, practice, experimentation and collaboration.

It reflects contributions from sustainability professionals, designers, educators, organisations and workshop participants who continue to explore better ways of creating positive environmental and social impact.

Thank you to everyone who has contributed to the ongoing development of this work.

The framework will continue to evolve as new ideas emerge and new challenges are explored.



About Green Spectrum

Green Spectrum is an operating system for sustainability transformation. It combines systems thinking, facilitation, sustainability practice and innovation into one connected methodology. Our mission is to help organisations move beyond compliance towards meaningful, measurable and regenerative change.

The Green Spectrum ecosystem includes:

- The Playbook
- Workshop System
- Canvas Library
- AI Coach
- Training Programmes
- Digital Platform
- Community

Learn more at:
www.greenspectrum.design



Green Spectrum

Operating System for Sustainability

Transformation



Green Spectrum provides the structure to help organisations understand complexity, align people and create meaningful sustainability outcomes.

**The future belongs to
organisations that can learn
faster than the challenges
they face**

Discover. Map. Structure. Prioritise. Decide. Experiment. Learn.



www.greenspectrum.design

